

AEGIS Pricing & Monetization Model

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Positioning

AEGIS occupies a unique position: **the only platform that combines browser-based de-identification, automated defacing, protocol compliance, QC, and BIDS conversion** in a single cloud-hosted service. Competitors force customers to choose between research tools (XNAT, Flywheel) and enterprise de-identification (ENCOG, MIRC CTP). AEGIS serves both from a shared core.

Pricing should reflect this dual-market advantage while remaining accessible to grant-funded academic labs.

Tier Structure

Tier 0: Open Source (Self-Hosted)

Price	Free (MIT license)
Target	Technical labs with DevOps capacity, evaluators
Studies	Unlimited
Projects	Unlimited
Storage	Customer-managed
Support	Community (GitHub Issues, Discussions)
Restrictions	No cloud AI backends (heuristic-only classification/PHI detection), no SLA, no managed upgrades

Why offer this: Builds adoption, generates contributions, establishes credibility in academic community. XNAT's open-source model proved this works — their hosted service (XNAT Central) converts a fraction of self-hosted users into paying customers.

Tier 1: Starter — \$0/month (Hosted Free Tier)

Price	Free
Target	Individual researchers, small pilot studies, evaluators
Studies	200/month
Projects	1
Storage	25 GB
Users	2 admin seats
Pipeline	Full automated pipeline (heuristic backends only)

Export shares	10 active shares
Support	Community
DIMSE	Not included
API keys	1

Conversion trigger: Storage or study limit hit → upgrade prompt with one-click plan change.

Tier 2: Research — \$499/month (annual) or \$599/month (monthly)

Price	\$499/mo annual (\$5,988/yr) or \$599/mo monthly
Target	Single-site research labs, small multi-site studies
Studies	3,000/month
Projects	5
Storage	500 GB (included), +\$0.10/GB/month overage
Users	10 admin seats
Pipeline	Full automated pipeline with cloud AI backends
Export shares	Unlimited
BIDS export	Included (per-study + bulk project export)
Protocol templates	20 per project
Webhooks	5 subscriptions
Support	Email (2 business day response)
DIMSE	Not included
API keys	5
Add-ons	DIMSE receiver (+\$200/mo), priority support (+\$150/mo)

Why \$499: Fits within a typical NIH R01 "other direct costs" budget line. Annual pricing generates a quote letter for grant applications. Competitive with Flywheel's entry tier (~\$500–800/mo estimated).

Tier 3: Consortium — \$1,999/month (annual) or \$2,499/month (monthly)

Price	\$1,999/mo annual (\$23,988/yr) or \$2,499/mo monthly
Target	Multi-site research consortia, CROs, academic medical centers
Studies	15,000/month
Projects	25

Storage	3 TB (included), +\$0.08/GB/month overage
Users	50 admin seats
Pipeline	Full automated pipeline with cloud AI backends
Institutions	20 (with IP/AE title attribution)
DIMSE receiver	Included (1 endpoint)
Protocol templates	Unlimited
Webhooks	25 subscriptions
Federation peers	3 (when federation launches)
Routing rules	Unlimited with import/export
Support	Email (1 business day response) + quarterly review call
API keys	20
SLA	99.5% uptime

Why \$1,999: Multi-site studies (ADNI, ENIGMA, ABCD-style) typically budget \$20K–50K/yr for data infrastructure. This tier captures that budget with room for add-ons.

Tier 4: Enterprise — Custom pricing (starting ~\$5,000/month)

Price	Custom (starting \$5,000/mo, typical \$5K–15K/mo)
Target	Hospital networks, pharma sponsors, large CROs, government agencies
Studies	Unlimited
Projects	Unlimited
Storage	Custom (multi-TB, negotiated)
Users	Unlimited admin seats
Pipeline	Full pipeline + custom sidecar integration
DIMSE receiver	Included (multiple endpoints)
SSO	IAP, Azure AD, Cognito (customer IdP)
Deployment	Shared multi-tenant or dedicated single-tenant
Data residency	Customer choice of cloud region (GCP, AWS, Azure)
Support	Dedicated account manager, 4-hour critical response
SLA	99.9% uptime, BAA execution
Compliance	SOC 2 Type II report, HIPAA BAA, optional GDPR DPA

Custom features	HL7 FHIR notifications, custom routing integrations, branded upload portal
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Usage-Based Pricing Components

In addition to tier base pricing, the following usage components apply:

Metric	Free	Starter	Research	Consortium	Enterprise
Studies/month	N/A	200	3,000	15,000	Unlimited
Overage per study	N/A	Blocked	\$0.25	\$0.15	Negotiated
Storage included	N/A	25 GB	500 GB	3 TB	Custom
Storage overage	N/A	Blocked	\$0.10/GB/mo	\$0.08/GB/mo	Negotiated
Cloud AI calls	N/A	N/A	Pass-through + 20%	Pass-through + 15%	Pass-through + 10%

Cloud AI pass-through pricing (approximate per-study costs):

- Gemini multimodal (classification/PHI): ~\$0.002–0.01/study
- Google Cloud Vision: ~\$0.001–0.005/study
- AWS Textract: ~\$0.002–0.008/study
- Azure Computer Vision: ~\$0.001–0.005/study

Most studies use heuristic backends (free) and only fall back to cloud AI when DICOM tags are missing.

Add-On Modules

Add-On	Price	Available on
DIMSE receiver	\$200/mo	Research
Priority support (1-day response)	\$150/mo	Research
Dedicated support (4-hour critical)	\$500/mo	Consortium
Additional DIMSE endpoints	\$100/mo each	Consortium, Enterprise
On-premises deployment license	\$25,000–75,000/yr	Enterprise (contact sales)
Protocol template pack (ADNI4, HCP, ABCD, UK Biobank, ENIGMA)	\$1,500 one-time	Research, Consortium
White-label upload portal	\$500/mo	Consortium, Enterprise
Custom BAA execution	Included	Enterprise

PACS integration consulting	\$250/hr	All tiers
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Discounts & Programs

Academic Discount

- **20% off** any paid tier with valid `.edu` email and institutional purchase order
- Stackable with annual billing discount

Grant Budget Letter

- On request: formal letter quoting AEGIS costs for NIH/NSF/DOD grant budget justification
- Includes: annual cost, description of services, HIPAA compliance attestation

Startup / Pilot Program

- **3 months free** on Research tier for new imaging startups (<\$5M funding)
- Requires case study participation at end of pilot

Volume Discount (Enterprise)

- 5+ projects: 10% discount
- 10+ projects: 15% discount
- Multi-year (2–3 yr commitment): additional 10%

Non-Profit / Government

- **15% off** for 501(c)(3) organizations and government agencies (VA, DoD, NIH intramural)

Revenue Streams Summary

Stream	Margin	Scalability	Notes
SaaS subscriptions	70–85%	High	Core recurring revenue
Storage overage	60–70%	High	Cloud storage cost + margin
Cloud AI pass-through	15–20%	High	Low margin but high volume
Add-on modules	80–90%	Medium	DIMSE, support, template packs
Professional services	40–60%	Low	Consulting, integration, onboarding
On-premises licenses	90%+	Low	High-value, low-volume

Billing & Payment

- **Payment methods:** Credit card (Stripe), ACH/wire, purchase order (Consortium + Enterprise)
- **Billing cycle:** Monthly or annual (prepaid annual = 2 months free)
- **Invoicing:** Net-30 for institutional POs
- **Currency:** USD (EUR and GBP available for Enterprise)
- **Cancellation:** Monthly plans cancel anytime; annual plans prorated refund for remaining months

Competitive Pricing Context

Competitor	Model	Approximate Price	Notes
Flywheel	SaaS subscription	\$500–5,000+/mo (estimated)	Research-focused, includes viewer and analysis
XNAT Central	Hosted service	Free (limited) / custom enterprise	Open-source self-hosted is free
ENCOG (Enlitic)	Enterprise subscription	Not public (est. \$3K–10K/mo)	Requires PACS integration
MIRC CTP	Open source	Free (self-hosted only)	No hosted option, no support
Ambra/Intelerad	Per-study or subscription	\$2–5/study or custom	Cloud PACS, limited de-identification
AEGIS (proposed)	Freemium + tiers	\$0–15,000/mo	Only platform covering both research + enterprise

AEGIS's free tier and \$499 entry point undercut all commercial alternatives while offering a broader feature set. The open-source option provides a floor that prevents vendor lock-in concerns.

Key Metrics to Track

Metric	Target (Year 1)	Target (Year 3)
Free tier signups	100+	500+
Paid conversions	10–15% of free users	15–20%
Average revenue per account (ARPA)	\$800/mo	\$1,500/mo
Net revenue retention	100%+	120%+
Monthly churn	<5%	<3%
CAC payback period	<6 months	<4 months

Implementation Notes

Metering Infrastructure

- Study count: already tracked in `studies` table (`created_at` per month)
- Storage: already tracked via `GET /api/storage/stats` and per-project `GET /api/stats/storage-usage`
- Cloud AI calls: add metering counter in classification/PHI detection service callbacks
- API key usage: already tracked (`last_used_at` on `api_keys`)

Billing Integration

- Stripe for credit card + subscription management
- Stripe Billing Portal for self-service plan changes

- Custom invoicing via Go service for PO-based enterprise customers
- Usage metering → Stripe Usage Records for overage billing

Plan Enforcement

- Middleware layer checking project count, study count, storage against plan limits
- Soft limits (warning at 80%) → hard limits (block at 100%) for studies and storage
- Grace period (7 days) for storage overage before blocking new uploads